

Cell Phones

Winner for cell phones is **NOKIA**



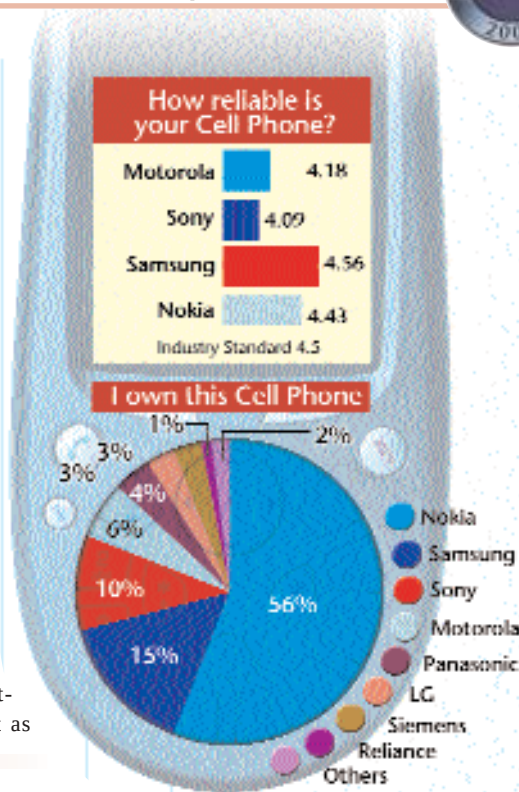
Cell phones have arrived. As a reminder, an especially irritating ring tone is probably calling to attention all living beings even as you read this; failing which, you are sure to run into someone with a hands-free kit, screaming right next to you in a crowded bus or train. Irritants at times, cell phones can hardly be ignored as great communication devices. With plummeting prices of both handsets and services, these amazing pocket-monsters will only proliferate.

Nokia's stranglehold in this particular segment is strong, and not entirely without merit. Of the 920 responses generated, an amazing 520 went Nokia's way. The closest competitor, Samsung, got a paltry 134 mentions, while Sony Ericsson and Motorola gathered 90 and 56 votes respectively. Not a fair fight by any means, and one that demanded that Siemens, Panasonic and LG pack up and

repairs in a two-year period, and a lower failure rate after purchase. This pushed Nokia to second place, followed by Motorola and Sony.

Nokia scored on service—problems were resolved the quickest; the satisfaction level with its technical personnel was the highest, as was the satisfaction with a repaired or a replaced unit. Interestingly, Sony Ericsson scored the lowest in satisfaction with repair, even though the company offers a stand-by unit to a customer to tide through the delay; something that Nokia does not.

One reader, who wishes to be unnamed, was not too happy with Nokia's services said, "It is very expensive, they charge labour for each component they replace...", while Sanmeet S Sahani was so put-off by Nokia's service that he went as



// The phone hung just like Windows; I had to search for the three magic buttons, [Ctrl], [Alt] and [Del]

// Suneel Mohan, on his Sony Ericsson T105 phone
Karnod, Andhra Pradesh

look elsewhere for the five per cent cut-off needed to be considered for the survey analysis.

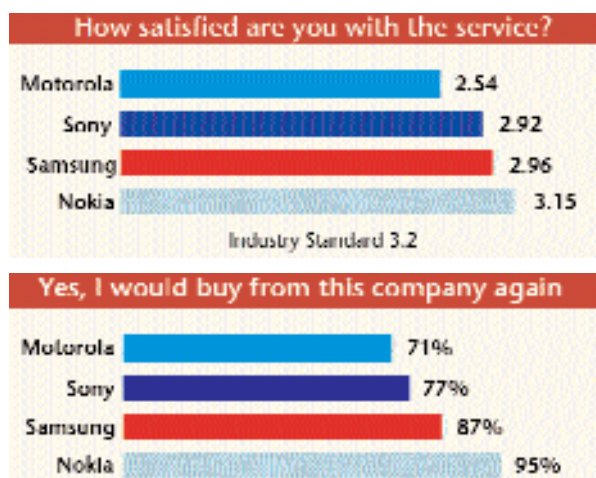
Nokia phones were owned the longest, with Samsung a close second. Samsung beat Nokia on reliability, by statistically scoring better on number of

far as to say, "I have been a Nokia fan for a long time, but after the service, I felt that Nokia has gone to the dogs..." Vidhu Bhushan, an associate professor, shed further light on the source of dissatisfaction by claiming, "The technical support staff lacks knowledge. It seems

as if they are equipped to provide only superficial answers, and not solve the problem in anyway. Also, these people do not know the salient features of various models and try to push either a very expensive or an inexpensive model towards the customers." Samsung was also chided for its service with this comment, "Samsung's service for comput-

Nokia earning the highest on its Service Index can be traced to the fact that consumers were especially happy with the **swift** manner in which it solved problems

ers is good, but for mobiles is very bad", while others pointed out that Samsung phones lack features. One reader said that the tie-up between Samsung and Reliance (the former provides sets for the latter's CDMA service) isn't making things easier for getting the handset repaired. Even Sony Ericsson took a thrashing on its service front: Jatinder Singh, a computer operator, thinks the company "still lacks the professional touch in India, especially in customer relationship. It will cost them dear if the situation is not addressed fast."



MOST RELIABLE CELL PHONE: Samsung RUNNER-UP: Nokia
MOST SATISFACTORY SERVICE: Nokia RUNNER-UP: Samsung